

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Grownups Buying Kids Toys

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 30

No.	Sentence
1	Adults purchasing children's toys for personal use make up between _____ of the total toy market
2	Marketers have coined a new word for such consumers: _____
3	In a single three-month period ending in December, American adults spent _____ on toys for themselves
4	Among the most sought-after items were _____, also known as plushies
5	These toys are constructed from cloth and packed with _____
6	The growing trend is largely fuelled by _____ and social media
7	Lisa runs a toy brand called _____, which specialises in leather plushies
8	Her business is headquartered in _____, Canada
9	She promotes her products _____
10	Her renewed interest in toys began once she secured a _____
11	She uses her spare money - known as _____ - to fund her hobby
12	Collecting toys helps her reconnect with her _____, a psychological concept referring to the childlike part of one's adult self
13	Jay runs a YouTube channel under the name _____
14	During the pandemic, a large number of new collectors entered the hobby, causing secondary market prices to _____
15	Many people joined because they had _____ - meaning plenty of free time - during lockdowns
16	Others had extra funds as they were no longer _____ on going out
17	The cost of sought-after items such as Pokémon cards and Jellycat plushies rose _____ throughout the pandemic

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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18	Kidult: a grown-up who enjoys _____ meant for younger audiences
19	Plushie: a soft toy stuffed with _____
20	To have time on your hands: to possess _____ with little to occupy oneself

What does Beth suggest about the current trend of adults purchasing toys?

- A It is a passing fad driven mainly by nostalgia and social pressure
- B It is more widespread than most people would initially expect
- C It is largely confined to collectors with specialist knowledge
- D It is a phenomenon that advertisers have been slow to recognise

According to the information given, which of the following best describes what "kidults" refers to?

- A Children who prefer adult-themed entertainment over traditional play
- B Marketers who design products targeting both children and grown-ups
- C Retailers who stock both children's and adult merchandise in one store
- D Grown-ups who have a genuine interest in products designed for younger audiences

What does Lisa Lee suggest was the primary condition that allowed her to resume buying toys as an adult?

- A Having financial stability and money to spend beyond her basic needs
- B Gaining recognition through her online channel and social media presence
- C Reconnecting with childhood friends who shared her interest in collecting
- D Receiving encouragement from her employer to pursue personal hobbies

According to Lisa Lee, what psychological function do toys serve for her beyond simple enjoyment?

- A They help her manage professional stress and workplace anxiety effectively
- B They give her a creative outlet for designing and crafting new products
- C They allow her to nurture and restore a childlike aspect of her adult self
- D They serve as financial investments that grow in value over time

What does Jay Glatfelter say happened to prices in the secondary toy market after the pandemic began?

- A They gradually stabilised as supply chains recovered and demand levelled off
- B They surged dramatically as a large wave of new collectors entered the market
- C They dropped initially before recovering as online platforms expanded their reach
- D They fluctuated unpredictably due to shortages in manufacturing and distribution

According to Jay Glatfelter, which combination of factors contributed to the rise in adult toy collecting during the pandemic?

- A Increased advertising by toy brands and a growing interest in retro culture
- B Government stimulus payments and the closure of major toy retail chains
- C Reduced working hours and a widespread desire to support local businesses
- D An abundance of free time alongside money that was no longer spent on outings

What can be inferred about the relationship between adult nostalgia and the cost of collectables during the pandemic?

- A Nostalgia had little measurable impact on the pricing of collectables overall
- B Collectors deliberately avoided high-priced items in favour of affordable alternatives
- C The emotional desire to recapture childhood memories contributed to rising prices
- D Manufacturers lowered prices strategically to attract nostalgic adult consumers

What is Phil's implied attitude when he describes the feeling of rediscovering childhood as something that "comes at a price"?

- A He acknowledges that emotional fulfilment through collecting involves a financial cost
- B He argues that toy collecting is an irresponsible use of disposable income for adults
- C He suggests that childhood memories are too precious to be assigned a monetary value
- D He warns that the toy industry is deliberately exploiting consumers' sentimental feelings

What does the example of the Lego Millennium Falcon most strongly suggest about the premium toy market?

- A Licensed products based on classic films consistently outsell all other toy categories
- B Lego sets are generally considered poor value compared to other collectable items
- C The Harry Potter franchise generates more consumer interest than the Star Wars brand
- D Certain collectable toys can command remarkably high prices in mainstream retail

Based on the overall discussion, what broader conclusion can be drawn about the adult toy market?

- A It is primarily sustained by a small group of wealthy enthusiasts with niche interests
- B It represents a significant and commercially influential segment of consumer spending
- C It is expected to decline once the social effects of the pandemic fully subside
- D It depends almost entirely on social media trends rather than genuine personal interest